



Dr Tumelo Chaka is an accomplished executive and board member with over 15 years of leadership experience across **financial services, media, retail, and technology**. He is recognised as **one of Africa's foremost authorities** on consumer behaviour and growth strategy, known for leading transformative initiatives that **integrate financial inclusion, digital innovation, and market expansion**. Strategic governance and commercial leader with over 15 years of experience driving inclusive economic growth and brand development across Africa. Brings a **unique intersection of finance, consumer behaviour, and digital transformation** — with a strong record of governance oversight, strategy execution, and stakeholder collaboration. Deeply committed to advancing South Africa's tourism economy, nation branding, and cultural intelligence through sustainable, market-driven innovation

He currently serves as a Board Member of **Boitekanelo College** in **Botswana**, where he contributes to the **Audit and Strategy Committees**, guiding the institution on its journey towards **university status**. His role focuses on financial integrity, risk governance, and strategic oversight to strengthen institutional sustainability and growth. Tumelo is a member of the **Africa CMO Council Advisory Board** and the **Gautrain Advisory Board** and **has represented Africa** as a speaker at **Advertising Week New York**. He was featured among the **Top 24 Leadership Voices of 2025 in The Future of Leadership** publication.

Previously, Dr Chaka held **leadership** positions at **Showmax, FNB, and Nedbank**, where he led groundbreaking commercialisation and growth strategies. At Showmax, he oversaw Africa Commercial Partnerships, building strategic alliances with leading corporates such as **MTN Nigeria, MTN Ghana, Safaricom, Vodacom Tanzania, Shoprite, Capitec, and Discovery** to drive regional expansion. His leadership at **FNB and Nedbank** focused on digital payments, emerging markets, and revenue growth through platform and partnership models that advanced financial inclusion across Africa.

Dubbed amongst the most respected and sought after consumer experts in the country by **Thebe Ikalafeng** in his **bestseller The Traveller**. Described by industry leaders as “**a brave entrepreneur**” (Ndaba Ntsele, **Chairman Pamodzi**), “**a game changer**” (Dr Reuel Khoza, **ex Nedbank Chairman**), “**You are an entrepreneurial brand**” (Dr David Himbara, **economic advisor to Rwandan President**) and “**a brand powerhouse**” (Khahliso Santho, **Financial Mail**).

He is completing his **CIMA** Chartered Global Management Accountant (**CGMA**) qualification and **SAICA APC** Board Exam for the Chartered Accountant **CA(SA)** designation. **PhD in Consumer Behaviour** focusing on consumer behaviour and household expenditure. Dr Tumelo Chaka speaks, writes, and advises on **consumer behaviour, platform businesses, power of retail in banking, partnerships in African markets** and **household consumption**.

CORE EXECUTIVE AND BOARD COMPETENCIES

- Governance and Risk Oversight
- Strategic and Financial Stewardship
- Inclusive Economic and Tourism Development
- Consumer Insights and Brand Strategy
- Digital Transformation and Platform Innovation
- Stakeholder Engagement (Public, Private, Community)
- ESG and Sustainability Governance
- Transformation and Human Capital Development

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE:

- **Chief Marketing Officer: Cultural Intelligence | United Stations (Pty) Ltd (2006 -**

Building strategy for emerging markets with media buying and media synergy strategies with media assets like **Kaya959, Algoa FM, Smile FM, OFM and Jozi FM**. Strategic revenue partner with blue chip brands and media buying advisory with clients like **Nedbank, Old Mutual, Checkers, Takealot, MTN, Vodacom, ABSA, Standard Bank**.

- **Managing Executive: Media, Strategy & Consumer behaviour | The Strategists (2024 - 2025**

Building global strategy for emerging markets with media buying and media synergy strategies for clients in Africa. Negotiating partnerships with multinationals for Africa strategy. Global immersions for African businesses and multinationals. Nation branding strategies with geopolitical strategy development and execution — Initiatives that enhanced **nation competitiveness** and **destination marketing**. Academic case study to be published on **Brand Rwanda** and its **health competitiveness**.

- **CEO Knowledge Management Advisory Panel | Gautrain Management Agency (2023 - 2025)**

Advisory Panel to the Chief Executive Officer and Executive Team with regards to growth of ridership, alignment of Gautrain to Destination Marketing and the brand of Gautrain as a Transport Node Asset of Gauteng and South Africa.

- **Executive: Africa Commercial Partnerships | Showmax (2024)**

Led cross-border strategic partnerships across **13 African markets**, positioning the **brand for growth** in **consumer engagement** and **digital content distribution**. Negotiated partnerships with MTN, Safaricom, and Shoprite ~ initiatives that enhanced **Africa's creative and digital economy**.

- **Africa Advisory Board: | Chief Marketing Officer Council (2023 – 2025)**

Advancing **global marketing excellence** and leadership insights, with a focus on **global marketing trends, digital transformation** and **brand leadership**. Collaboration with global marketing leaders (CMO) to shape brand strategy, consumer engagement and innovation. ~ this role enhanced bridging global **brand governance insights** to **translate global marketing excellence** into destination

competitiveness for South Africa through **connecting data** and **brand authenticity to customer and brand growth**.

- **Executive Head: Revenue Growth and Customer Channels | FNB (2021 – 2023)**

Directed inclusive growth **strategy** for the entry market, expanding **financial access** to over 3.5 million new clients in the township and rural economy. Initiatives contributed to **national transformation** and **economic inclusion** looking at South African Minibus Industry with 15 million commuters servicing 9 million households in South Africa building an investment business of over R6,8bn stokvel investment and South Africa Social Security Agency (SASSA) beneficiary financial services solution ~ directly relevant to **brand and township economy growth**.

- **Head: Commercialisation Emerging Payments & Head Sales Strategy: Forex and Investments | Nedbank (2019 – 2021)**

Oversaw payment innovations to advance financial inclusion and digital adoption. Strategic understanding to leverage investments locally and build strategies to enhance Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) for growth in the South African economy. Alignment of **Commercialisation of payment** linked to **Digital Transformation, Innovation, Forex and Investments** ~ skills essential to developing **sustainable tourism payment ecosystems** and **emerging economies**.

- **Executive: Alternative Investments | Senate Capital (2015 – 2019)**

Led investment strategy and commercial turnaround initiatives across private markets and infrastructure projects. Served on Gauteng Provincial Hospitals Board to strengthen governance and financial performance in the health sector ~ skills essential to developing foreign **direct investments (FDI)**

- **Executive Head: Emerging Markets | Alchemy Investments (2012 – 2015)**

Championed new markets penetration and scalable solutions in emerging markets in Sub Saharan Africa. Build investment partners in Africa, China and South Korea. With a focus on broadband infrastructure, commodities and logistics. ~ skills essential to developing foreign **direct investments (FDI)**

- **Senior Manager: Public Sector Banking | ABSA (2010 – 2012)**

Directed public sector banking with customer and revenue growth. Understanding and integrated knowledge of IFRS, PFMA and Corporate Finance to build business cases to effectively solution for clients. – skills essential to understanding **public sector** effectively **financial management**.

- **Entrepreneurship: Brand Insights & Strategy | Qurious Insights & Strategy (2007 – 2009)**

A entrepreneur in the branding and experiential marketing industry. ~ skills essential to competitive brand strategy and strategies to **compete as a national and global brand**.

- **Trainee Accountant | PricewaterhouseCoopers PwC (2005 – 2007)**

SAICA Audit Trainee accountant with focus on clients in Financial Service, SOEs, Telecommunication.
~ skills essential to understand a range of businesses in various industries with regards to **Financial Accounting, Financial Management, Taxation and Auditing.**

EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL DESIGNATION

PhD Business Science & Consumer Behavior	(2025)	- University of Cape Town
Master's in Business Administration (MBA)	(2014)	- GIBS
Postgraduate Diploma in Business Administration	(2012)	- GIBS
Bachelor of Accounting.	(2006)	- University of Free State

IN PROGRESS PROFESSIONAL DESIGNATIONS

Chartered Marketer CM(SA) (Board Exam in November 2026	- MASA
CIMA: ACMA CGMA designation (last exam August 2026)	- CIMA
SAICA APC CA(SA) Exam(last exam December 2027)	- SAICA

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